CAYMAN BID DESK · CIMA REGULATORY WATCH

CIMA AML audit readiness checklist

The rule is now in force, and these records need to be ready whenever your independent AML audit or a CIMA inspection asks for them. Five items to keep current under CIMA's Rule on Effective Compliance Programme for the Prevention and Detection of ML, TF and PF.

Last reviewed 4 November 2026 · Sources: cima.ky/aml-cft-faqs and the rule (PDF, CIMA)

- [ ] **1. Who performs your audit, and why they're independent**

  A written record naming the auditor and showing they have no responsibility for the design, operation, management or oversight of your programme. Your AMLCO, MLRO or DMLRO can't audit the programme they're part of, whether employed or outsourced.

- [ ] **2. Your audit frequency and the reasoning behind it**

  The rule sets no fixed interval. Record the frequency, scope and depth you chose and tie it to your documented risk assessment. CIMA's illustration: about two years for higher risk, three for medium, four for lower risk firms.

- [ ] **3. Your external audit cycle**

  At least one audit in every three independent audit cycles has to be external. Record when your last external audit took place and when the next one falls due.

- [ ] **4. For funds: evidence tied to the individual entity**

  A fund that outsources nearly everything still needs an AML audit. Relying only on a service provider's internal audit or a population-based review isn't enough. Keep evidence on that fund's onboarding, due diligence, third party arrangements, internal reporting, training and record keeping.

- [ ] **5. Board oversight records**

  Minutes, reports, documented decisions and tracked remediation actions showing the governing body received, reviewed and acted on compliance reporting.

> **Need help organising this evidence?** Cayman Bid & Compliance Services supplies documentation and project capacity. Call or WhatsApp +1 (343) 301-5061 or visit www.caymanbiddesk.com.

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